

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting July 6th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MYQymF8BeAw
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 6, 2026

Governing Body: Delaware County Board of Commissioners (Muncie, Indiana)

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:09:42](#).
- **Attendance:** Presiding Officer / Board President (identified in transcript as Commissioner Reagan), Commissioner Henry, and Commissioner Bram.
- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening invocation followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:09:48](#).
- **Employee Recognition [00:10:21](#):** Zach Whitliff was recognized as Employee of the Month for his exceptional work on the Delaware County website migration project, specifically restructuring the Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission (DMMPC) website over a 12-week period.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

Approval of Minutes

The board reviewed and approved past meeting minutes individually: - **June 3, 2026 Executive Session Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote [00:18:45](#). - **June 15, 2026 Regular Meeting Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote [00:19:21](#). - **June 18, 2026 Executive Session Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote [00:19:52](#). - **June 19, 2026 Special Meeting Minutes:** Approved after Commissioners Henry and Bram provided a public verbal summary of the meeting [00:23:12](#) due to technical recording failures. - **June 25, 2026 Special Meeting Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote [00:23:34](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **[00:24:13](#) Property Purchase Request (1943 West 8th Street):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Robinson (Resident of 1940 West 9th Street).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Robinson requested to purchase the county-owned, vacant tax-sale lot directly behind his property to clean it up and plant a garden. Commissioners noted the property is currently in the county's name, but specific legal protocols and tax-sale requirements must be met before disposal.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled to the July 20, 2026 meeting for investigation [00:25:30](#).
- **[00:29:07](#) Road Right-of-Way Dedication (650 South):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Ice (Ashton Land Surveyor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dedication of road right-of-way on 650 South to facilitate splitting off a home for a family member while joining the remaining southern parcel to an existing family property.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:29:55](#).
- **[00:30:16](#) IRA Funding Request:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mrs. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested \$75,000 for the Delaware County IRAX program for 2026. Discussion ensued regarding multi-year funding commitments, state funding changes under Senate Roll Back Act No. 1 taking effect in 2028, and city vs. county contributions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for \$75,000 for the year 2026 by roll call vote (2-1, with Commissioner Reagan voting "No") [00:36:06](#).
- **[00:40:49](#) Justice Center Memorial for Fallen Sheriff's Deputies:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners and County Engineer Dean.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed a permanent memorial at the justice center dedicated to Delaware County Sheriff's deputies killed in the line of duty

(specifically noting Blake Reynolds). Estimated preliminary site work cost of \$16,000 plus monuments totaling around \$10,000.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a not-to-exceed amount of \$50,000 funded out of EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) Capital Project Fund 12 by roll call vote [00:44:21](#).
- **[00:45:56](#) Resolution of No Confidence in Marion County Prosecutor Ryan Mears:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners, supported by Prosecuting Attorney Eric Hoffman and Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Read aloud a joint resolution declaring a vote of no confidence in Marion County Prosecutor Ryan Mears, citing elevated violent crime rates, individuals traveling from Marion County to commit serious crimes in Delaware County, and the resulting financial and public safety burdens placed on local taxpayers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [[00:45:56](#) / [00:50:31](#)].
- **[00:48:50](#) Justice Center Fire Security Monitoring Equipment:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers (Superintendent of Maintenance).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for additional Corson Fire Security equipment, reprogramming, and monitoring setup at the justice center to satisfy fire marshal requirements.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for \$3,120 by roll call vote [00:52:35](#).
- **[00:45:54](#) Accurate Controls Two-Year Service Agreement:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Maintenance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formalized a two-year service contract for the jail door access control and monitoring system (Silver Level) totaling \$60,453.33 (\$30,226.66 per year) plus an additional software management agreement totaling \$12,400.28 to ensure system software updates.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both agreements approved for a two-year period, to be paid out of EDIT capital project funds, by roll call vote [[00:54:56](#) / [01:08:10](#)].
- **[00:55:27](#) Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) Agreement:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylen Swackhammer (Plan Commission) along with David Baird and Matthew Oorc (American Structure Point).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of a 14-month project to rewrite and unify zoning regulations, subdivision controls, and sign ordinances for both the county and the city. Total cost for optional items (including post-adoption support) is \$168,925, with 80% covered by federal/grant funds (\$135,140) and the remaining 20% local match split between city and county (\$16,892.50 each). A \$5,000 Ball Brothers Foundation grant has already been secured.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [01:06:51](#).
- **[00:45:54](#) Bridge 30 Warranty Deeds:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Engineering.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Acceptance of two warranty deed right-of-way parcels for Bridge 30 (Eaton Albany Pike over ditch) for \$1,500 and \$2,900 (noting a clerical error in written words vs. numbers corrected via amendment).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with amendment by roll call vote [01:10:22](#).
 - [01:10:36](#) **LPA Contract for Bridge 509 (McGalliard over Muncie Creek):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** USI Consultants / County Engineering.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approval of a \$760,000 contract for design and initial right-of-way acquisition. \$680,000 is an 80/20 federal/local split; the remaining \$80,100 is temporarily 100% county responsibility while additional funding is sought.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [01:11:43](#).
 - [01:11:58](#) **Human Resources Leadership Appointment:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following the resignation of HR leader Josh Jarvis, commissioners recommended promoting Lee Royal (who has 3.5 years in the HR department and nearly 5 years total HR experience) to the position of Human Resources Leader, and posting her former position to backfill.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [01:21:41](#).
 - [01:21:44](#) **Recorder Media Conversion Agreement:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dan Smoot (Delaware County Recorder).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Re-evaluated a digitization and scanning project contract totaling \$168,744.83. Following State Board of Accounts consultation regarding service/data processing contracts and single-source software compatibility, the vendor agreed to split payments into two installments. Funded out of the Recorder's perpetuation fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [01:27:19](#).
 - [01:34:43](#) **EDIT Plan Figures Update:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Clean up of Excel spreadsheet formulas (auto-sum totals) matching the previous EDIT plan proposal without altering underlying fund figures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [01:36:14](#).
 - [01:50:51](#) **Financial Claims, ARP Claims, and Payroll Approvals:**
 - **Payment of Claims:** Approved as amended (totaling \$69,347,713.53) by roll call vote [01:55:20](#) (Commissioner Bram voted "No" [01:55:17](#)).
 - **ARP Claims:** Approved in an amended amount of \$3,095 (\$675 for Unique Computer Services plus \$2,420 for administrative fees) by roll call vote [01:55:54](#).
 - **Payroll (July 1, 2026):** Approved for \$1,707,020 by roll call vote [01:56:32](#).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:56:52 Mark Creps** (1611 North Tillison Avenue, Muncie): Representing the Sons of the American Revolution, requested and received approval for a public reading of the Declaration of Independence at the county plaza on Wednesday, July 8th at noon.
- **01:59:56 Cheryl Swingley** (Delaware County resident): Addressed the board comparing solar energy projects favorably against data centers, raising concerns regarding data center stress on electrical grids, water usage, noise, light pollution, health impacts, and lack of a specific data center ordinance, calling for a moratorium on data centers.
- **02:03:17 Rick Yenser** (Newsman/Author): Spoke regarding local government spending transparency, upcoming income tax combinations, and community development trends surrounding Muncie's commercial corridors.
- **02:05:55 Leonard Reese** (421 West Oakville Road / Monroe Township Trustee): Thanked the commissioners for blight removal progress, highlighted remaining dilapidated/unsafe structures in Oakville and Cowan, and discussed township weed control enforcement challenges.
- **02:10:51 Rita Faulner** (1515 West Bethel Avenue, Muncie): Seconded Cheryl Swingley's request for a moratorium on data centers.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:**
 - 4-H Fair events scheduled from July 11th through July 22nd at the fairgrounds.
 - Purdue Extension relocating to the fairgrounds July 8th through the 22nd.
 - Monroe Township Lions Club car show scheduled for July 27th.
 - Upcoming executive session to be scheduled regarding airport authority funding and attorney-client privileged matters.
- **Adjournment & Recess:** At **02:23:29**, the board voted to enter a 15-minute recess prior to convening the Stormwater Board meeting at 11:30 AM (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call **02:34:45**).